- The amount that is usually accepted by health care providers in the same geographical area (or greater area, if necessary) for the same services, treatment, or devices received by the member; or
- Current publicly available data (including but not limited to pricing data published by the US Department of Veteran Affairs, RJ Health, and Medicare) reflecting the costs for health care providers providing the same or similar services, treatment, or materials adjusted for geographical differences plus a margin factor above cost.
- Or, fee(s) that are negotiated with the physician or facility.

To estimate our maximum Plan allowance for a non-network provider before you receive services from them, call us at 800-821-6136. For more information, see *Differences between our allowance and the bill* in Section 4.

You should also see *Important Notice About Surprise Billing - Know Your Rights* in Section 4 that describes your protections against surprise billing under the No Surprises Act.

**Post-service claims** Any claims that are not pre-service claims. In other words, post-service claims are those claims where treatment has been performed and the claims have been sent to us in order to apply for benefits.

**Pre-service claims** Those claims 1) that require precertification or preauthorization and 2) where failure to obtain precertification or preauthorization results in a reduction of benefits.

**Preauthorization** A decision made by your health plan that a healthcare service, treatment plan, drug, surgery, or durable medical equipment is medically necessary after review of medical information. Sometimes called prior approval.

**Precertification** The process of collecting information and obtaining authorization from the health plan prior to an inpatient admission or other selected ambulatory procedures and services.

**Primary care provider** Physician that focuses on a range of prevention, wellness, and treatment for common illnesses. Primary care providers include doctors, nurses, nurse practitioners, and physician assistants who are practicing within the scope of their license and are credentialed and designated by the Plan to be a primary care provider. They often maintain long-term relationships with patients and treat a range of health-related issues. Doctors listed in provider directories or advertisements under any other medical specialty or sub-specialty area (such as internal medicine doctors also listed under cardiology, or pediatric sub-specialties such as pediatric allergy) are considered specialists, not primary care providers. Chiropractors, eye doctors, dentists and audiologists, are not considered primary care providers.

**Rehabilitative** Therapy is initiated to restore bodily function when there has been a total or partial loss of bodily function due to illness, surgery, or injury.

**Reimbursement** A carrier's pursuit of a recovery if a covered individual has suffered an illness or injury and has received, in connection with that illness or injury, a payment from any party that may be liable, any applicable insurance policy, or a workers' compensation program or insurance policy, and the terms of the carrier's health benefits plan require the covered individual, as a result of such payment, to reimburse the carrier out of the payment to the extent of the benefits initially paid or provided. The right of reimbursement is cumulative with and not exclusive of the right of subrogation.

**Sound natural tooth** A sound natural tooth is a whole or properly restored tooth that has no condition that would weaken the tooth or predispose it to injury prior to the accident, such as decay, periodontal disease, or other impairments. For purposes of the Plan, damage to a restoration, such as a prosthetic crown or prosthetic dental appliance (i.e., bridgework), would not be covered as there is no injury to the natural tooth structure.

**Speech generating devices** Electronic voice output communication aids, which are electronic augmentative and alternative communication systems used to supplement or replace speech or writing for individuals with severe speech impairments.